



down. After a measured half hour, Raphinha broke the deadlock with a precise finish into the bottom-right corner past Thibaut Courtois.

This set the ball rolling for a chaotic end to the first half, with Vinicius producing a brilliant solo run and finishing down the left to equalise in the second minute of stoppage time. Two minutes later, Lewandowski restored Barcelona's lead after meeting a perfectly weighted through ball from Pedri. Again two minutes later, Kylian Mbappe's stand-in Gonzalo Garcia found the net after Barca failed to clear its lines from a corner.

The second half continued in the same vein and Raphinha completed his second consecutive brace in the competition's final in the 73rd minute. His right-footed shot from the edge of the box took a deflection off Raul Asencio before looping over a helpless Courtois. Mbappe's introduction and Frenkie de Jong's

late red card gave Real a glimmer of hope, but missed chances in stoppage time proved costly as it watched its arch-rival lift a record 16th Spanish Super Cup.

The defeat proved the final straw for Real, which parted ways with coach Xabi Alonso soon after.

Updated as of January 12

Jubilant scenes: Barcelona claimed its 16th Spanish Super Cup with a hard-fought win over Real Madrid.

Below: Macclesfield players celebrate after stunning Crystal Palace 2-1 in the FA Cup — the first time since 1909 a non-League side beat a defending champion in the tournament. AP & AFP

